Community letters

Here are just a few letters the Editors has recieved from you, the readers

Adapting designs

Bob and Mark,
I enjoyed Bob's article in *Woodturning* 286. It arrived a couple of weeks before Christmas and I needed to make new designs for friends. I followed the directions, but since I needed to make a number of pieces in a hurry, I made one change. Instead of putting a shoulder on the lower part after drilling, I put a spigot on the top part to fit in the hole. I held the spigot in short jaws and it was quicker for me to fit. I used round toothpicks for the perch. I also made the display stand that was described and sprayed it black. When friends came by the house for a little cheer and mentioned the bird houses, I let them pick one. It was fun and I did not have to wrap a gift. Thanks for the article and I really enjoy the magazine.

Maury

Bob's reply

Hi Maury,
Thanks for your email – it's great to know that my articles are read, enjoyed and are useful. I like your modification – it's simple and I can see advantages. Something I had to be careful about was not to hit the recess while I was shaping the curve of the lid. Your modification would overcome that problem.

Bob

Maury's reply

Mark and Bob
Bob's comment was why I made the change. I ruined several tops before I made the change. I love the imagination of the Hobbit books and was thinking of them when I made these bird houses. I like whimsy and humour in turning, and other things.

Maury

Bob Chapman's Christmas decorations in holly (*Ilex aquifolium*)

Andrew Norris' twisted stem candlestick

TURNED CANDLESTICKS

Mark,
In *Woodturning* 283, you published a photo of a pair of candlesticks I had made. I subsequently started another pair in laburnum (*Laburnum anagyroides*). When the roughed-out bases and tops were assembled to the finished spindles, my sister-in-law saw them and said she preferred the bulkier look, rather than the shape of the originals. My wife agreed so I drew out a few alternative silhouettes and came up with the end result as the attached photo.

I think the ladies were right and the new shape is better. My current project is a lidded box with a carved handle, based on Neil Scobie's article. I really appreciate the ideas and inspiration I get from your excellent magazine and read it avidly every month.

Regards, Andrew Norris

Banjo?

First off I want to tell you how much I enjoy your magazine. I look forward to each issue every month. I'm trying to find out why the banjo is named the banjo. I've asked a number of turners including some professional turners and nobody seems to know. Thanks for your help.

Neil Creter Macon, GA, USA

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